

Connections

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CLT's Newest Runway Opens



Charlotte Douglas International Airport's newest runway, 18R/36L, became fully operational on Friday, February 12, 2010. Federal, state and local dignitaries were among those in attendance at a special commemorative event hosted by Charlotte Mayor Anthony Foxx and held on the new taxiway to mark this historic moment in North Carolina's aviation

history. Prior to a ribbon cutting, Mayor Foxx proclaimed February 12, 2010 "a day to celebrate Charlotte Douglas International Airport and its significance to our community and its impact on aviation history." A bald eagle, who resides at Carolina Raptor Center, was named Lady CLT (spoken as Charlotte) and her portrait was unveiled to the audience in honor of

the runway's completion. A ribbon cutting signaled the official opening and full operation of CLT's third parallel runway, followed by commemorative landings on the new runway of a vintage Piedmont Airlines' DC-3, a NCANG C-130 and a US Airways' Airbus.

Runway 18R/36L is the first new runway at CLT since the opening of Runway



18C/36C in 1979, more than thirty years ago. Construction wrapped up in December 2009 on the Airport's third parallel runway. Charlotte Douglas also has one crosswind runway. For passengers and airlines, the new runway will result in a decrease in arrival and departure delays. The addition of the new runway will permit triple independent landings at CLT and will save airlines

an estimated \$65 million in annual delay avoidance costs. Runway 18R/36L's primary purpose is for flight arrivals. CLT averages more than 750 arrivals each day.

Construction began in March 2007. The runway construction project, including road relocation and adjoining roadway

Continued on page 3.

US Airways Announces CLT/Rome Service

What's Inside

Airport's New Fire Station Going Up

CLT's Visitor Info Center Opens with New Improvements

Runway 5K Run Drives Record Crowd





CLT Continues Customer Service Improvements

VISITOR INFO CENTER

The new Visitor Info Center opened Friday, January 15, 2010 in the Arrivals/Baggage area with several improvements. The new center features enhanced lighting and red and white décor, making it easy for people to locate. Three large plasma screens are located behind the desk and display advertising and snapshots and videos of Charlotte. The screens can also broadcast breaking news. The Visitor Info Center is managed by the Charlotte Regional Visitors Authority (CRVA) and is

visited by an average of 14,000 people a month.

ARRIVAL/DEPARTURE INFORMATION MONITORS

New Flight Information Display System (FIDS) monitors are being installed

throughout the Airport. FIDS monitors provide passengers and employees with arrival and departure information, including destination, airline, gate number and flight time. The current monitors were installed in the



early nineties. The new FIDS are designed to be cleaner, more open and complement the modern feel of the terminal. The text on the screen is larger and airline logos can be displayed. They also use less energy and produce less heat. All new monitors are scheduled to be in place by the end of 2010.

WILSON AIR CENTER-CLT

New flooring and furnishings have been installed at Wilson Air Center-CLT, the Airport's FBO. Improvements include additional lighting, increased seating in an open space environment and additional workstations for pilots and customers. Wilson Air Center continues to be recognized as an industry leader and is a favorite among pilots. It was recently named the #1 FBO Chain among pilots in *Professional Pilot Magazine's* 2009 PRASE survey.

EXTERIOR SMOKING AREAS MODIFIED

The Airport has modified the smoking areas on the front curbside of the terminal. The smoking areas have been renamed "Designated Smoking Area" (previously named "Courtesy Smoking Area"). New signage has been placed. All other areas on the curbside are now marked as "No Smoking" areas. The Airport's smoking areas are suggested locations and are designed to address customer service requests from smokers and non-smokers. ■



CLT DESIGNATED SMOKING AREAS

- Far west end of the Departures/Ticketing area
- Far west end of the Arrivals/Baggage area
- Far east end of the Arrivals/Baggage area



Bald Eagle Named in Honor of New Runway Opening

Lady CLT is a juvenile bald eagle and is mixture of brown and white. She is nine months old and will receive her white head when she reaches maturity at the age of four to five years.

non-releasable due to permanent damage to her wing. She is now being trained to be an ambassador bird and will make her permanent home at Carolina Raptor Center.

Carolina Raptor Center is dedicated to the environmental stewardship and the conservation of birds of prey through education, research, and the rehabilitation of injured and orphaned raptors. The center is located in Huntersville, N.C. near Latta Plantation. For more information, visit the center's website at: carolinaraptorcenter.org. ■

The Carolina Raptor Center has named a rehabilitated bald eagle "Lady CLT" (pronounced Charlotte) in honor of the commissioning of the Airport's new third parallel runway, 18R/36L. The announcement and unveiling of Lady Charlotte's photograph took place during the commissioning event, held February 12, 2010.

Lady CLT came to the Raptor Center in 2009 from Anson County after being found by the US Fish and Wildlife Service on a riverbank in Wadesboro. She was emaciated and wounded. Her wing would not extend beyond 45 degrees. Six months later, Lady Charlotte returned to normal weight but has since been declared

New Runway Opens

Continued from page 1.

construction, costs total \$325 million - \$124 million came from the FAA in a letter of intent to assist with construction of the

new runway. Additional funding for the project came from federal grants and proceeds of the 2007 and 2009 General Airport Revenue Bonds, which will be repaid with Passenger Facility Charge (PFC) revenues. ■

RUNWAY 18R/36L FACTS

- 9,000 feet long
- 650 acres construction site
- Over 10 million cubic yards of dirt moved
- 2 taxiway bridges
- Over 700 companies involved in planning, design and construction of runway and related road projects
- Approximately 311,545 cubic yards of concrete used to pave runway
- Total thickness of runway pavement 24 inches
- New runway permits triple independent landings
- Runway construction project, including road relocation, adjoining roadway construction and land acquisition, costs total \$325 million
- Airlines estimated to save \$65 million in annual delay avoidance costs